

The Art of Being ALONE: Solitude Is My HOME, Loneliness Was My Cage

Renuka Gavrani

Blue highlight | Page: 6

Why do you hate the idea of being with yourself so much that the time you spend with yourself is now considered 'loneliness'?

Blue highlight | Page: 9

The fear of loneliness has been injected into our minds since we were kids. We have learned that the kid who eats alone sits alone, and has no friends is pathetic.

Blue highlight | Page: 9

No one wants to be seen as a 'weirdo', hence, our dread of being alone.

Blue highlight | Page: 9

It's our life, but we live as per the rules of society.

Blue highlight | Page: 9

so many people don't act on their goals because they are worried about what people would think of them. What if people laugh at them? What if they fail and everyone sees them as a failure?

Blue highlight | Page: 10

'You'll stop worrying what others think about you when you realize how seldom they do.'

Blue highlight | Page: 13

it's not pathetic to be alone. I realized that we don't hate being alone. We hate to believe that we have been left behind. And that, as we learned as a child, should be considered pathetic. Well, bullshit!

Blue highlight | Page: 13

The simple truth of life is: people leave, for good or bad, and life goes on.

Blue highlight | Page: 15

Being alone is a part of life. But being lonely means viewing yourself from the lens of sympathy and misery. When you look at yourself through the lens of loneliness, you feel insecure and left out. You start thinking that there is something wrong with you. And that lowers your self-esteem. You start treating the time you spend with yourself as a bad thing. That's loneliness and it has nothing to do with you being alone. That just defines what you think of yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 16

In a world where being alone is considered a curse, you should get up and use it to your advantage.

Blue highlight | Page: 17

'The scary news is, you are on your own now. But the cool news is, you are on your own now.'

Blue highlight | Page: 17

It's a complete myth that being alone means being lonely. No, darling, that's not

Blue highlight | Page: 17

true. Being alone doesn't mean you are lonely.

Blue highlight | Page: 17

Being alone means you are with yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 23

is

Blue highlight | Page: 24

If you start imagining every person who is nice to you as your future buddy because you are so desperate to make friends, then you are practically digging a graveyard of your hope. And let me tell you one thing from experience: If there is anything that can be crueller than death, it's nurturing false hope in your heart just to see it crushing every piece of you at the end.

Blue highlight | Page: 26

Since childhood, we have learned that the kid who is alone is a weirdo.

Blue highlight | Page: 27

The more thought you give to what people think of you, the less attention you give to what you want, what you like, what you think, how you would like to enjoy life, and more importantly what makes you you.

Blue highlight | Page: 28

In the race of achieving people's acceptance and love, you end up losing yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 29

We do the things that seem cool instead of trying new things that our soul wants.

Blue highlight | Page: 30

'There are some days when you miss yourself more than you have ever missed anyone else.'

Pink highlight | Page: 46

Every day take out at least 10–15 minutes to just be with your soul. You must take some time to know yourself, a time when you don't have to fake it and when you can completely accept yourself without any judgements or fear.

Blue highlight | Page: 55

learning about yourself is a lifelong process. You change every day a little. You evolve with every song, every book, every article, every video, and every thought you come across. This is the reason why sitting just once and defining yourself wouldn't work. If you want to know yourself, you have to be interested in yourself for the rest of your life.

Yellow highlight | Page: 55

And you must remember one thing: You are beyond a particular tag. You cannot be labelled. Be undefinable.

Blue highlight | Page: 58

go ahead and make a list of everything that you think you are not, or what you never want to be. While I was in college, almost every other student used to drink. I never touched it even when my friends asked me to at least try. Why? Because I knew I was not this and I never will be.

Yellow highlight | Page: 59

"If you compromise with your principles once, it will become your habit to cheat your principles and do what's cool."

Blue highlight | Page: 70

“Some people are alone because they don’t have friends or family. Some people practise being alone because they want to stay connected to themselves.”

Blue highlight | Page: 71

‘There is a kind of freedom in being alone.’

Blue highlight | Page: 72

Georgia O’Keeffe is not the first nor the only artist who found inspiration in solitude. History is filled with examples of legendary artists, warriors, and writers who found their hearts speaking to them directly when they spent time with themselves.

Blue highlight | Page: 72

‘The mind is sharper and keener in seclusion and uninterrupted solitude.

Blue highlight | Page: 73

Be alone, that is the secret of invention; be alone, that is when ideas are born. That is why many of the earthly miracles have had their genesis in humble surroundings.’

Blue highlight | Page: 73

how ‘all the great writers, artists and inventors choose to spend time with no distractions so that they can connect with something deep within themselves and create a true masterpiece.’

Blue highlight | Page: 74

The irony is, where our generation is treating ‘solitude’ as loneliness, something to escape and feel ashamed of, there was a time in history when all the great minds sought solitude to travel inward. Solitude was once a luxury to experience the calmness of the world that lives inside us.

Yellow highlight | Page: 74

solitude helps us reach our greatest potential.

Orange highlight | Page: 74

Look around you and you will observe the people who are setting boundaries and working on their goals/dreams are the ones who don’t have a large group of friends. They are the ones who are alone – not because they are miserable and pathetic, but because they are choosing to leave the noise behind.

Pink highlight | Page: 75

People who are up to something, people who are working towards their future or busy creating their art don't have time to feel lonely. Rather they crave to be alone so that they can focus.

Blue highlight | Page: 77

Your real guidance is YOU. Your heart knows what needs to be done and your mind is capable enough to figure out the 'how.'

Blue highlight | Page: 77

They all knew that to create real art, they had to become real with themselves first. Hence, they chose solitude.

Blue highlight | Page: 78

solitude is the only way to create real art.

Blue highlight | Page: 84

They all said the best ideas come into their mind when they are not looking for them or not doing anything at all.

Pink highlight | Page: 86

being purposely idle is

Orange highlight | Page: 86

In a world where you have thousands of options at your fingertips to enjoy, it's an art to know how to feel completely satisfied with doing nothing.

Blue highlight | Page: 87

control. You learn how to be bored like an artist. And then your mind rewards you with the most amazing creative ideas. The kind of ideas that you never expected.

Pink highlight | Page: 90

'Make your life your own little garden where you have all types of (flowers, as in) people and interests and hobbies, so that you always have something or someone to love and receive love. Have friends you love, enjoy the hobbies you are passionate about, and play with your pet. Create things and build that relationship around you that keeps you excited so that love is always around you in one form or the other. Life will be more colourful that way.'

Blue highlight | Page: 92

'You are who you are, whether you like it or not, so why not like it?'

Blue highlight | Page: 94

the path to success is lonely

Blue highlight | Page: 95

I am asking you to become friends with your goals and dreams, with success and achievements. I am asking you to start afresh with yourself. I am asking you to look at your alone time through the lens of a highly successful person and think about how they will use their time. And if you think about it, it's neither loneliness nor solitude. It's just time. How you

Blue highlight | Page: 95

to look at your alone time through the lens of a highly successful person and think about how they will use their time.

Blue highlight | Page: 97

You and I are manipulated into believing that success means a big house, lots of money, and aesthetic pictures from vacations.

Blue highlight | Page: 98

behaving like clowns. We are following everything that people in power want to make us do. We think if we don't have

Blue highlight | Page: 98

The problem is that we are making our lives a collection of cheap dreams that everyone imagines and materialistic shit that everyone else possesses.

Blue highlight | Page: 100

you should take some time every day to be alone so that you can think independently without the influence of anyone.

Blue highlight | Page: 102

"Learn to define your definition of everything. Don't make your life a wish list of what you think everyone has."

Blue highlight | Page: 103

'When you don't know what you want, then you want to have everything glittery and shiny.'

Blue highlight | Page: 105

You need to sit down and start defining things for yourself. Do you want to be happy? Great! What does happiness mean to you? Dig deeper and figure out the things that make you happy and how you can add a little dose of happiness to your day-to-day life.

Blue highlight | Page: 106

You need to sit down and make a conscious list: what are some of the things you don't like in yourself or your life?

Blue highlight | Page: 107

To be able to create your dream life one day, you will have to act like your dream version every day.

Blue highlight | Page: 107

Life doesn't change one day magically. You change how you live every day.

Blue highlight | Page: 107

You cannot become the person of your dreams if you don't imagine what your dream version looks like and if you don't know what is wrong with your current version.

Blue highlight | Page: 109

Before you demand anything from others, learn to be honest with yourself. Have the courage to accept that you were the one killing all your dreams.

Blue highlight | Page: 109

honesty with yourself is the toughest thing.

Blue highlight | Page: 110

You cannot change everything at once. If you try to, you will just burn yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 110

The catch is to focus on one thing at a time.

Blue highlight | Page: 113

After reading over 200 books, if there is anything that I have understood, it's this: action is the cure for almost everything.

Blue highlight | Page: 118

Take out a piece of paper and write in front of that big issue one action goal. Yes, make it clear enough for yourself what's the one action you will perform every day to get closer to your destination. And then no matter what, do it.

Blue highlight | Page: 119

One of the basic things about human nature is the more you force yourself into doing something, the more you will feel low and depressed – like it's been imposed on you.

Blue highlight | Page: 121

Working on our goals should be fun and exciting, not exhausting. Now, to make it fun, we need to allow ourselves to be flexible – to free ourselves from traditional methods of achieving goals.

Blue highlight | Page: 121

You need to find out how you like to work and what time you work the best. You must feel empowered whenever you take action on your goals.

Blue highlight | Page: 122

I am moving towards my goals every day but in a way I want. I am not forcing myself to do a certain thing in a certain way. It's my life and I will achieve my goals in ways I am comfortable in. I suggest you do the same. Instead of making things a burden for you, make things fun. Shake it up a bit. Focus on what you would like to do today and how can you make even the mundane things fun. The point is you

Blue highlight | Page: 127

you what is the one thing you do every day to make yourself happy, what would you say? Hard to answer, I know. I have been

Blue highlight | Page: 127

We don't feel exhausted because we try too hard. We feel exhausted because we do too little of what truly makes us happy.

Blue highlight | Page: 128

You have waited enough for others and the world to bring joy to your life. Now it's your turn to intentionally create a joyful life. Not just a happy life but a joyful life. Happiness is a cheap thing. Joy makes life rich.

Blue highlight | Page: 129

everything turns into fun when you do it with full self-awareness.

Blue highlight | Page: 129

It's in the small moments that you can find joy hidden for you to find it. Play with it. Joy is playing hide-n-seek with you. It's your task to find it somewhere deep inside your heart.

Blue highlight | Page: 130

I strongly suggest you try to find joy in little things.

Blue highlight | Page: 131

Your heart already knows where joy lies for you. Follow your heart's guidance and let it lead you to create a joyful day-to-day life. The point is either you find joy or the worry finds you."

Blue highlight | Page: 132

We all have time. Time is not the issue if you truly want to do something. The issue is your habit of making silly excuses.

Blue highlight | Page: 134

Make your alone time addictive by learning something, and doing things that you like. Try something that you always wanted to do. Ask yourself what you wanted to learn but you never gave your interest enough attention. Is it dancing? Learning a new language?

Blue highlight | Page: 134

is, just focus on learning it. Make your alone time your growth time.

Blue highlight | Page: 136

You can choose to read the books that make you feel excited and help you grow in life.

Pink highlight | Page: 137

books are powerful and words hold the power to change your entire life.

Blue highlight | Page: 138

Books are not boring. Books are magical! They hold the power to transform you into your dream version.

Blue highlight | Page: 139

Enough of excuses and drama. You have got so much to look forward to. So much to grow and learn. And books are the easiest way to learn and grow in life.

Blue highlight | Page: 139

Make it your goal to feed your brain with knowledge.

Blue highlight | Page: 141

don't let time slip from your hands. Educate yourself, train yourself, and most of all have fun with yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 143

too. It's not anyone's job to satisfy your desires or manifest your imagination into reality.

Blue highlight | Page: 144

Do the things that you want to do with others. But with yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 146

It's been a long time since you have been waiting for others to understand your desires and then turn them into reality. It's time you do everything that you desire with yourself.

Blue highlight | Page: 147

"Romanticize the actions that you take for yourself. Acknowledge your desires and turn them into something better than your imagination. It's all about making an effort for yourself."